

42 Reporting with passives

One way to distance yourself from facts is to use the passive voice and reporting verbs. This device is commonly used in newspaper and television journalism.

-  **New language** Passive voice for reporting
- Aa Vocabulary** Reporting language
-  **New skill** Distancing yourself from facts

42.1 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTING WITH PASSIVES

A number of structures and reporting verbs can be used in the passive voice to distance the writer or speaker from the facts.

"IT" + PASSIVE REPORTING VERB

"THAT" CLAUSE

It has been reported that three sailors have disappeared.

SUBJECT +
PASSIVE REPORTING VERB

INFINITIVE CLAUSE

The race is known to be extremely dangerous.

"THERE" +
PASSIVE REPORTING VERB

"TO BE / TO HAVE BEEN"

There are said to be at least 20 boats in the search party.



42.2 MATCH THE BEGINNINGS OF THE SENTENCES TO THE CORRECT ENDINGS

Unfortunately, it was announced

1 There are thought to be more than

2 Maria Callas is believed by many

3 The escaped criminal is not thought

4 It is hoped

5 The damage is expected

to cost more than \$50,000 to repair.

that many new jobs will be created.

6,000 languages in the world.

that 500 employees would lose their jobs.

to be a dangerous threat to society.

to have been the most talented singer ever.

